Tim Everard

Esports Tournament and Player Operations

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PROFILE

Esports operations professional with 15 years in esports, live events and broadcast, most recently heading Esports Operations at BLAST. Hands-on tournament and player operations, online and offline, across the shooting titles CS2 and CS:GO alongside Dota 2, Rocket League, Fortnite and Apex Legends. Across six years at BLAST that meant 60+ flagship events and 300+ qualifiers in 13 countries. Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams, and brought online and offline player management into one team. Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams. Comfortable across the whole tournament ecosystem, from freelancer and vendor booking to event-day delivery. Based in Surrey.

60+	300+	13	2,000+
flagship esports events	qualifiers	countries	freelancers

EXPERIENCE

Head of Esports Operations — Jun 2023 – Oct 2026
BLAST

- Led a six-person department running tournament operations across every BLAST ecosystem, including the shooting title CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams
- Set technical requirements for commercial partnerships
- Designed and built the department's own tools for tournament operations, event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Rebuilt how the department works, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs

KEY SKILLS

Tournament operations
Online and offline tournament planning, player operations, event logistics, bootcamps

Shooting titles
CS2, CS:GO, Rainbow Six, Apex Legends

Partners and players
Tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams, stakeholder management

Freelancers and vendors
Freelancer booking, contracting and payments, rotas, vendor management

Commercial and finance
Budgets, pitch costings, invoices, business cases

Systems and tooling
Airtable, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office

Safeguarding and safety
Designated Safeguarding Lead, first aider, fire marshal

CERTIFICATIONS

First Aid at Work	2022
Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	2021
Working at Heights	2018
Moving Head Maintenance	2018
Manual Handling	2018
Fire Marshal	2018
PAT Testing	2016
IPAF	2012

References available on request.

Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

BLAST · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams
- Managed tournament equipment and staffing budgets across the shooting title CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six
- Booked and managed tournament operations freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair tournament kit
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events

Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

Self-employed · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angels and Create Broadcasting
- On-stage admin at esports events, and consulted on production and technical setups for clients
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows

Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Jam Television · Birmingham

- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Hired freelancers and ran staff rotas to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air, including holiday cover and emergency call-outs
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing
- Managed suppliers, invoice approval and day-to-day maintenance, including software and hardware updates
- Trained staff on studio equipment and workflows

Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

ESL UK · Leicester

- Managed production for both studios and at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Built and set up the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios
- Hired freelance crew, managed rotas and supervised internal and external staff on live shows
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live broadcasts
- Trained crew on equipment and workflows, and ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance

Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

Dorking Halls · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne
- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas, from lighting and audio desks to 35mm and digital projectors
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager
- Carried out PAT testing on the venue's electrical equipment